MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Cloud Infrastructure Engineer | QA Automation Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including hands-on ownership of CI/CD pipelines, Kubernetes-based ephemeral test environments and build tooling. Experienced in improving pipeline performance, automating environment lifecycle tasks and creating monitoring dashboards. Personal infrastructure experience includes a k3s homelab managed with GitOps and Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure. Currently preparing for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), k3s, Terraform (personal Hetzner infrastructure; personal project), Argo CD
Monitoring & data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL
Programming & scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems: Linux, Git, Ansible (basic), AWS (EC2 and S3 fundamentals through personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage; monthly CI runner costs decreased by about 30%.
- Designed and implemented the application-level architecture for short-lived merge-request environments, combining Docker Compose and later Helm-deployed Kubernetes components for the application, PostgreSQL, seeded data, automated cleanup, and end-to-end testing.
- Enabled QA and product stakeholders to review features before merge by providing short-lived merge-request environments with seeded application and PostgreSQL data.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built a Python and PostgreSQL workflow to collect CI test results and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Write Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and authored an internal guide to CI pipelines used in onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

Personal Infrastructure Projects

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Set up a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Designed and operated monitoring and ingress components using Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Traefik, and cert-manager for TLS certificate management.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam preparation; exam scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)